University of Florida
College of Public Health & Health Professions Syllabus

PHC 6530: Public Health Issues of Mothers and Children (3 credit hours)

Spring: 2026
Delivery Format: Online
Course Website: UFL E-Learning
Class Meeting: Wednesdays, Periods 6-8 (12:50pm – 3:50pm)

Instructor Information

Instructor Name: Julie Moderie, MPH
Room Number: NA
Phone Number: 352-262-9989
Email Address: jul03uf@ufl.edu
Office Hours: By appointment
Preferred Course Communications: email

Prerequisites

The course is designed for second year MPH students, but other majors and academic levels may be approved at discretion of instructor.

PURPOSE AND OUTCOME

Course Overview

The first purpose of the course is to develop a working knowledge of key public health issues affecting mothers, children, and families, primarily in the United States. Following an introduction to key organizational and financing issues in the field, the course focuses in greater depth on major public health problems, and specific local, state, and federal programs and policies that have been implemented to address them. The second purpose is to provide opportunities to integrate this population-specific content with public health skills as they are applied in practice situations. The role of data in understanding and addressing public health problems, and the importance of evidenced-based public health practice are emphasized throughout the course.

Course Objectives and/or Goals

Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to:

1. Describe historical roots and contemporary structure of maternal and child public health services in the United States.
2. Identify and discuss major public health problems of mothers and children and their key determinants.
3. Describe the programmatic and policy interventions developed to address major public health problems of mothers and children.
4. Analyze one specific MCH problem in-depth and propose a valid and specific recommended intervention for addressing this problem in the future.

Instructional Methods

Consistent with the spirit of graduate education and the interactive nature of public health practice, students are expected to attend and participate fully in every class session. Each person's frequency and quality of contribution to the class discussion will be assessed and reflected in the class participation score. Students are expected to answer and ask questions, make comments, and join in discussion. If you cannot attend a class, it is important that you inform your professor in advance. Excessive unexcused absence will result in recommending that you withdraw from the course.

DESCRIPTION OF COURSE CONTENT

Topical Outline/Course Schedule

Week	Date(s)	Topic(s)	Assignment(s) Due
1	1/14	INTRODUCTION TO COURSE AND HISTORY OF MCH	
2	1/21	MCH INDICATOR DATA AND COURSE PAPER AND PRESENTATION STRUCTURE	MCH and Public Health
3	1/28	TOBACCO USE DURING PREGNANCY AND HRSA MCH BUREAU	
4	2/4	MATERNAL MORTALITY AND RESPECTFUL MATERNITY CARE	Perinatal Health Data Analysis
5	2/11	PERINATAL MENTAL HEALTH	
6	2/18	COURSE TOPIC – PART 1 PAPER	Description of the Problem
7	2/25	FETAL & INFANT MORTALITY, ACCESS TO CARE AND PREVENTION EFFORTS	
8	3/4	INFANT NUTRITION: BREASTFEEDING	Data Analysis
9	3/11	SUBSTANCE USE DISORDER DURING PREGNANCY	Social Ecological Model and Justification for Action
10	3/18	SPRING BREAK	
11	3/25	INFANT/CHILD SAFETY AND CHILDREN'S SERVICES COUNCILS	Problem Diagram and Analysis Narrative
12	4/1	HOME VISITING PROGRAMS AND FATHERHOOD INVOLVEMENT	Modifiable Precursors Table
13	4/8	FAMILY PLANNING AND REPRODUCTIVE HEALTH	Interventions and Logic Models
14	4/15	COURSE TOPIC – PRESENTATIONS	Presentation
15	4/22	COURSE TOPIC – PRESENTATIONS	Presentation

Classes will be held on Zoom using the following link:

https://ufl.zoom.us/j/95805057794?pwd=qR0FyZjH1ZthtWBbETm8aZLW3OdVtt.1
Meeting ID: 958 0505 7794
Passcode: 393983

Course Materials and Technology

Required readings are listed on the Topical Outline/Course Schedule and can be found on the course e-learning site.

Instructional materials for this course consist of only those materials specifically reviewed, selected, and assigned by the instructor. The instructor is only responsible for these instructional materials.

For technical support for this class, please contact the UF Help Desk at:

- helpdesk@ufl.edu
- (352) 392-HELP - select option 2
- https://helpdesk.ufl.edu/

Additional Academic Resources

- Career Connections Center: Reitz Union Suite 1300, 352-392-1601. Career assistance and counseling services.
- Library Support: Various ways to receive assistance with respect to using the libraries or finding resources.
- Teaching Center: Broward Hall, 352-392-2010 or to make an appointment 352- 392-6420. General study skills and tutoring.
- Writing Studio*:* 2215 Turlington Hall*,* 352-846-1138. Help brainstorming, formatting, and writing papers.
- Student Complaints On-Campus: Visit the Student Honor Code and Student Conduct Code webpage for more information.
- On-Line Students Complaints: View the Distance Learning Student Complaint Process
- Enrollment Management Complaints (Registrar, Financial Aid, Admissions): View the Student Complaint Procedure webpage for more information.

ACADEMIC REQUIREMENTS AND GRADING

Assignments

1. **Attendance and Class Participation.** Consistent with the spirit of graduate education and the interactive nature of public health practice, students are expected to attend and participate fully in every class session. Each person's frequency and quality of contribution to the class discussion will be assessed and reflected in the class participation score. Students are expected to answer and ask questions, make comments, and join in discussion. If you cannot attend a class, it is important that you inform the professor in advance. Excessive unexcused absence will result in recommending that you withdraw from the course.
2. **MCH and Public Health.** Written response on the importance of maternal and child health in the field of public health.
3. **Perinatal Health Data Analysis.** Analyze perinatal health indicator data to identify trends, disparities, and public health implications.
4. **Course Topic Analytic Paper on one public health problem of mothers, children, and/or families.** This paper will address one MCH problem from a public health perspective, including significance and determinants; key interventions, effectiveness, and impediments to effectiveness; and a recommended intervention derived from the preceding analysis. The paper is developed in multiple parts. Specific guidelines for the paper will be distributed early in the semester. Topics must be approved by the course instructors.
5. **Course Topic Presentations.** The presentations will follow the same format as the paper and will be presented live at the end of the semester.

Grading

Requirement	Due date	Points
Class Participation		**10**
Class Assignments		**10**
MCH and Public Health	1/21/2025	*3*
Perinatal Health Data Analysis	2/4/2025	*7*
Course Topic Paper		**70**
1. Description of the Problem	2/18/2025	*15*
2. Data Analysis	3/4/2025	*10*
3. Social Ecological Model and Justification for Action	3/11/2025	*5*
4. Problem Diagram and Analysis Narrative	3/25/2024	*15*
5. Modifiable Precursors Table	4/1/2025	*5*
6. Interventions and Logic Models	4/8/2025	*10*
7. Recommended Intervention	4/15/2025	*10*
Course Topic Presentation		**10**
8. Class Presentation	4/15/2025	*10*
Total Points		**100**

Point system used

Percentage Earned	Letter Grade
93-100	A
90-92	A-
87-89	B+
83-86	B
80-82	B-
77-79	C+
73-76	C
70-72	C-
67-69	D+
63-66	D
60-62	D-
Below 60	E

Please be aware that a C- is not an acceptable grade for graduate students. The GPA for graduate students must be 3.0 based on 5000 level courses and above to graduate. A grade of C counts toward a graduate degree only if based on credits in courses numbered 5000 or higher that have been earned with a B+ or higher.

Letter Grade	Grade Points
A	4.0
A-	3.67
B+	3.33
B	3.0
B-	2.67
C+	2.33
C	2.0
C-	1.67
D+	1.33
D	1.0
D-	0.67
E	0.0
WF	0.0
I	0.0
NG	0.0
S-U	0.0

More information on UF grading policy may be found at:
https://gradcatalog.ufl.edu/graduate/regulations/#Grades *[Remove if course is an undergraduate level course.]*
https://catalog.ufl.edu/UGRD/academic-regulations/attendance-policies/ [Remove if course is a graduate level course.]

Policy Related to Make Up Exams or Other Work

Late work will not be accepted unless discussed and approved by the instructor in advance.

Please note: Any requests for make-ups due to technical issues MUST be accompanied by the ticket number received from LSS when the problem was reported to them. The ticket number will document the time and date of the problem. You MUST e-mail me within 24 hours of the technical difficulty if you wish to request a make-up.

Policy Related to Required Class Attendance

Attendance will be taken at the beginning of each class and when class resumes after a break.

Students are required to have their camera on during class. First and last name should be used as the student's Zoom display name.

It is expected that students notify the instructor if they will arrive late, need to leave early or be absent from class.

Excused absences must be consistent with university policies in the Graduate Catalog (https://gradcatalog.ufl.edu/graduate/regulations/#Attendance%20Policies). Additional information can be found here: https://catalog.ufl.edu/ugrad/current/regulations/info/attendance.aspx

Policy Related to AI Use in This Course

The use of AI in this course is not permitted. **The use of AI on assignments, essays/reflection papers, exams, and quizzes when prohibited by course or college instructions is considered cheating** and students are violating the UF Regulations 4.040 Student Honor Code and Student Conduct Code.

ACADEMIC POLICIES & RESOURCES

University academic policies and resources can be found at: https://syllabus.ufl.edu/syllabus-policy/uf-syllabus-policy-links/

STUDENT EXPECTATIONS, ROLES, AND OPPORTUNITIES FOR INPUT

Expectations Regarding Course Behavior

Students are expected to attend every class with their camera turned on and actively participate in the discussion.

Communications Guidelines

Netiquette Guidelines: https://teach.ufl.edu/wp-content/uploads/2020/04/NetiquetteGuideforOnlineCourses.docx

PHHP Student Resources

PHHP's UPTurn (Unified Pathways to Support Wellness) program is a *no-cost mental health and wellness program* that is offered year-round to all PHHP students (undergraduate, graduate and professional level) and students (from any college) who are enrolled in PHHP courses. UPTurn advisors support students on their wellness journeys by curating individualized plans (resources and support) to help them manage academic, social, emotional, and health-related stress.

Interested students are paired with an UPTurn advisor, who meets with each student *virtually* (Zoom, Teams, phone) or *in person* (private office/room in HPNP) for a 45-minute consultation, followed by (if desired):

1. Up to 4 follow-up skills-building visits
2. When needed and appropriate, up to 10 psychotherapy sessions after completion of the 4 follow-up skills-building visits

Note: UPTurn is NOT a crisis/emergency resource. Students who are in crisis are strongly encouraged to use UF's existing crisis support resources, which are listed here: https://counseling.ufl.edu/services/crisis/

Students can learn more about UPTurn and request an appointment here: https://phhp.ufl.edu/student-resources/upturn-wellness-program/
Any questions regarding UPTurn can be directed to upturn@phhp.ufl.edu or (352) 273-6850.

Inclusive Learning Environment

Public health and health professions are based on the belief in human dignity and on respect for the individual. As we share our personal beliefs inside or outside of the classroom, it is always with the understanding that we value and respect diversity of background, experience, and opinion, where every individual feels valued. We believe in, and promote, openness and tolerance of differences in ethnicity and culture, and we respect differing personal, spiritual, religious and political values. We further believe that celebrating such diversity enriches the quality of the educational experiences we provide our students and enhances our own personal and professional relationships. We embrace The University of Florida's Non-Discrimination Policy, which reads, "The University shall actively promote equal opportunity policies and practices conforming to laws against discrimination. The University is committed to non-discrimination with respect to race, creed, color, religion, age, disability, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity and expression, marital status, national origin, political opinions or affiliations, genetic information and veteran status as protected under the Vietnam Era Veterans' Readjustment Assistance Act."